

Dear 16-Year-Old *You*

Trace the blame, the love, the quiet start, and the castle you built — then write the letter your future self owes you.

NAME

DATE

AGE YOU'RE WRITING TO

1

Trace Your Own 'First Blame'

- Name **one path** — art, business, trade, sport — you never dreamed of at 16, simply because no one put it in front of you.
- Who was your *only role model* growing up? Whose ambitions did you catch **like a fever** once you left that bubble?
- Name the **mediocre, peaceful life** you sometimes wonder if you'd have been happier living.
- Write **one sentence** to your parents about a choice they made for you without meaning harm.

ROADS NOT TAKEN

2

Map Where Love Became Your Engine

- List the **ambitions** in your life driven by love, unrequited love, or heartbreak — not pure ambition.
- Describe one time your love *was not reciprocated*. What did it build in you instead of break?
- Where has **self-doubt** gotten dangerously loud in your head? Name the moment.
- What would you **make** — write, build, start — out of your next heartbreak instead of just surviving it?

LOVE AS FUEL

3

Find Your 'Writing Articles Online' Moment

- Name the small, unglamorous start you're underrating right now — *lyrics for songs that don't exist*, a journal, a half-built app.
- What **two cents** do you have to offer the world that you haven't shared yet?
- What decision — like **moving to Germany** with a hidden second agenda — could serve a practical need *and* your real pursuit?
- Describe **one person** among the 1,000 who'd follow your story if you started telling it publicly.

SMALL STARTS

4

Name Your Castle and Its Monsters

- Where do you feel **loneliness** even surrounded by people — and what wall did you build there?
- Name one person you let in who brought *chaos*. What did letting them go actually look like?
- Who are the few who've kept the **sanctity of your castle** intact? Have you told them that?
- Write **one line** of the letter your future self, ten years from now, would send back to you today.

CASTLE & MONSTERS